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ElevenLabs

Deployment Strategist Lead

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Dear ElevenLabs team,

Day three in Jordan. Oil refinery. The database had failed to deploy and no one at BP could explain why: every step of the procedure had been followed correctly, verified twice. I had no internet access, no support line, and a project deadline that had not moved. So I deployed a dead-switch in the infrastructure room to isolate the network segment, proved conclusively that the fault was on the client side, and had the system running by end of day. On schedule. That is not a war story. That is a job description.

I'm applying for the Deployment Strategist Lead role because the work you're describing is exactly what I have been doing across my entire career, first in oil and gas field deployments across four countries, and more recently in building the AI infrastructure and innovation programs that help organizations actually use new technology instead of just buying it. The pattern is always the same: complex system, unfamiliar environment, stakeholders who need convincing, and no one else on-site to call. I thrive in that setup. I know how to read a room, read a contract, and read a stack trace, often in the same afternoon.

The AI deployment context is not hypothetical for me. At Windesheim University I built and operate a self-hosted AI stack from zero: Flowise, n8n, OpenWebUI, Supabase, Docker on Linux. I designed the governance and AVG-compliance layer, onboarded researchers and students, and PM'd the Value Chain Hackers program which uses that infrastructure for enterprise-grade supply chain compliance auditing. I understand what it takes to get AI tools past the procurement committee, past the IT security team, and past the end users who have never touched anything like it. That last part is the hardest and it is where I spend most of my energy.

One thing I want to address directly: the role description implies a significant travel commitment for a forward-deployed position. I want to be straightforward. My current work structure involves concurrent part-time engagements. If ElevenLabs is building a Benelux team and this role can be structured to reflect that geography (with the travel focus on Benelux and EMEA rather than global constant travel), I am fully prepared to make this the dominant commitment. The chance to build a regional forward-deployed team from zero, at a company doing genuinely interesting work in voice AI, is exactly the kind of 0-to-1 challenge I am built for. I would rather have that conversation openly than not have it at all.

I am happy to go deeper on any of the deployment stories, the AI stack specifics, or the team-building track record in a conversation.

With best regards,

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